



The animal's tusks were extended upper incisors—in humans, these are the two front teeth.

Powerful jaw muscles helped *M. borsoni* grind down its fibrous plant food.



TOOTHED TITAN

MAMMUT BORSONI

Remains of the gigantic *Mammuth borsoni*—one of the largest mammals ever to walk on land—suggest it could have reached a weight of 17.6 tons (16 tonnes), which would make it heavier than some of the giant sauropods. Like modern-day elephants, *M. borsoni* was a herbivore, and every day it would have ground down vast quantities of tough vegetation with its massive molar teeth. Its huge tusks are the longest ever known. Fossils of this animal have been unearthed at sites in Asia, Africa, Europe, and North America. One specimen discovered in Greece had particularly large tusks, at a record-breaking length of 16½ ft (5 m).

STATS AND FACTS

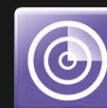
Although *Mammuth borsoni* is a contender for the crown of “largest land mammal,” some animals, such as its cousin *Palaeoloxodon* and the rhino relative *Paraceratherium*, might have been bigger.

LIFESPAN



Like modern-day elephants, *M. borsoni* may have lived for up to 71 years.

ORIGIN



M. borsoni first appeared in what is now Europe before it migrated to Asia.

